

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The patient is describing symptoms of depression , such as feeling sad , hopeless , and suicidal ideations , which have been present for a long time . He also mentions difficulty making decisions and guilt from past problems , which are common symptoms of depression .

The patient's symptoms of energy and concentration worsening over the past 2 weeks could be indicative of a depressive episode .

There is no mention of mania or psychosis , so option B is not the best answer .

There is no indication that the patient is experiencing anhedonia , which is a lack of pleasure in activities , so option C is not the best answer .

Option D is not supported by the information provided , as there is no mention of paranoid personality disorder symptoms .

Therefore , the correct answer is the one that describes the patient's condition as being at risk for double depression , which is a common term used to describe someone who experiences multiple episodes of depression . </think><answer> The patient is at risk for double depression . </answer>

